

Pricing services like CoinCap don't list XRP's total available supply as the 100 billion that Ripple lists²⁷ but only include the ripple that has thus far been distributed to the public, which is just north of 37 billion units.²⁸ A word to the wise for the innovative investor: with a new cryptocurrency, it's always important to understand how it's being distributed and to whom (we'll discuss this further in Chapter 12). If the core community feels the distribution is unfair, that may forever plague the growth of the cryptocurrency.

Ripple has since pivoted away from being a transaction mechanism for the common person and instead now “enables banks to send real-time international payments across networks.”²⁹ This focus plays to Ripple's strengths, as it aims to be a speedy payment system that rethinks correspondent banking but still requires some trust, for which banks are well suited.

Dogecoin

A somewhat comic cryptocurrency addition arrived on December 8, 2013 (less than two weeks after bitcoin hit a notable high of \$1,242) in the form of dogecoin.³⁰ Dogecoin was launched as a riff off Doge the dog, which *Wired* magazine had pegged as 2013's meme³¹ of the year.³² Doge was a Shiba Inu dog whose image with captions of an internal monologue went viral.

Dogecoin was initially floated as a joke. Jackson Palmer, who worked in the marketing department of Adobe's Sydney offices and was a cryptocurrency enthusiast, sent the tweet: